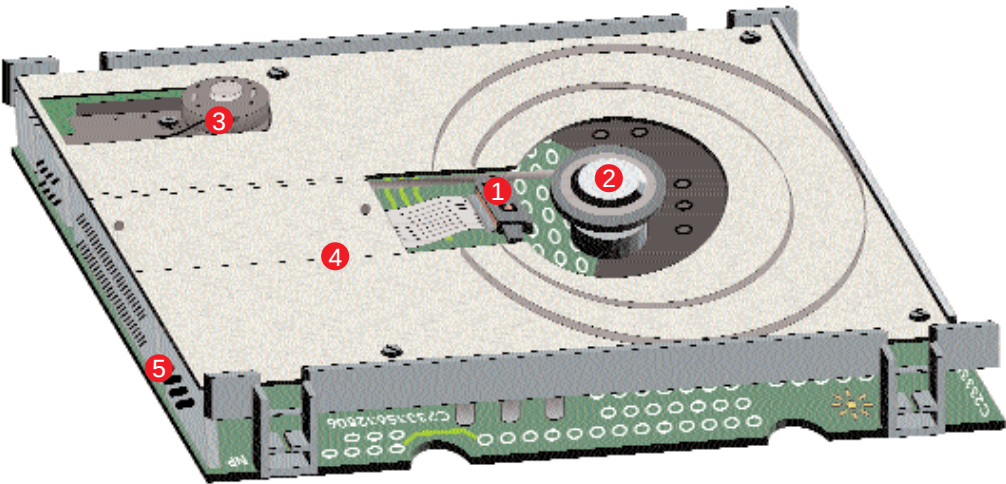




Buying Tips

- ✓ **SPEED:** Drives these days come in 12X and 16X speeds. Opt for a 16X.
- ✓ **FORMATS:** Take a look at the various formats the drive can play. Most DVD players can't play all formats. For example, the drive may not be able to read a DVD-RW disk. In this case, if you have several DVD-RWs, a new DVD-ROM would be a bad investment.
- ✓ **READING CAPABILITY:** Ensure that the drive can read dual-sided DVD media.
- ✓ **WARRANTY:** Ask for the warranty period, as well the parts covered by the warranty. Look for a drive that comes with a replacement warranty. Also ask the dealer if he will provide a standby drive, in case your current drive is under repair.
- ✓ **MEMORY:** Make sure you buy a DVD-ROM drive that has a buffer memory of at least 512 KB.
- ✓ **SOFTWARE BUNDLING:** Ensure that good DVD playback software is provided along with the drive.
- ✓ **HARDWARE PROVIDED WITH DVD-ROM DRIVE:** Some DVD-ROM drive manufacturers provide an external decoding card with their drives. Check if the card is compatible with your computer, and if proper drivers and software are provided.
- ✓ **SYSTEM RESOURCES:** DVD-ROM drives consume a lot of system resources when playing DVD movies. Make sure you have adequate system resources before you purchase a DVD-ROM drive.

- 1 Drive lens:** A DVD-ROM has a greater data density than a CD-R. So, the drive lens uses a high intensity laser to read data from such media.
- 2 Disk motor:** This motor controls the rotational speed of the disk. These have high spin speeds.
- 3 Tracking motor:** This motor takes care of the laser assembly and moves to read data from the inner to the outer tracks on the DVD.
- 4 Drive tray:** It's the tray in which you place the DVD. Some drives feature a slot interface, thereby doing away with the tray.
- 5 Connectors:** The IDE and power connectors are placed at the back of the drive.

Do Remember

- The development of the DVD format started in 1994, and it was only in 1996 that it was launched.
- A single-speed DVD-ROM drive has a data transfer rate of 11.08 Mbps. Hence, a 16X DVD-ROM can transfer data up to 177 Mbps.
- People usually associate DVD disks with movies. However, DVDs are also used to distribute games and other material such as encyclopaedias.
- DVD-ROM drives can play all the DVDs and above that it can even read all the CDs.
- The DVD-ROM format has 4 standardised options: DVD-5 (single-sided, single-layered with a capacity of 4.7 GB), DVD-9 (single-sided, dual-layered with a capacity of 8.5 GB), DVD-10 (dual-sided, single-layered with a capacity of 9.4 GB) and DVD-18 (double-sided, dual-layered with a capacity of 17 GB)
- To check the formats supported by your DVD ROM drive, use the Nero Info tool. This is a freeware utility available on the Nero Web site. Once installed, run the utility and under the Drive tab you will get the information about which formats your DVD drive supports.
- The DVD-R pattern was introduced in 1997. It was capable of recording up to 3.9 GB of data per disc. Later the DVD-RW format was introduced in 2001, and is capable of recording 4.7 GB of data per disc.



Quick Find

YOU NEED	To view DVD movies
Basic Use	
LOOK FOR	Any DVD-ROM drive
YOU NEED	A drive that will let you transfer data at the highest speeds
Inter Use	
LOOK FOR	A 16X DVD-ROM drive

The Future

The market clearly indicates that CD-ROM drives have taken a back seat; it's the DVD-ROM drives that most consumers are now eyeing. A year ago, one of the reasons why users were unwilling to migrate to a DVD-ROM was the premium pricing of DVD disks. As things stand today, one can buy a DVD disk ranging from a mere Rs 200, to Rs 1,200. This indicates that manufacturers want to ensure that the technology is widely accepted; we can therefore expect to see a rise in the sales of DVD-ROM drives.